

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7)

Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	13 — वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. This supplementary chapter teaches vowel-quantity (mātrā). Watch the classic traps: Sanskrit has THREE vowel quantities - ह्रस्व (short, 1 mātrā), दीर्घ (long, 2), प्लुत (prolonged, 3) - not two; a मात्रा is a unit of TIME (the duration of a short vowel); रौति is SINGULAR ('it crows') while रुवन्ति is PLURAL; and वर्ण here means a sound/letter (phonetics), not caste. Match the Sanskrit bird/animal names correctly. Sanskrit is quoted in Devanagari. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. वर्णमात्रा refers to a vowel's:

- (A) colour (B) caste
(C) duration (how long it is sounded) (D) spelling

2. A मात्रा is a unit of:

- (A) weight (B) distance
(C) money (D) time (duration)

3. The मात्रा is defined as the duration of a:

- (A) short vowel (B) long vowel
(C) prolonged vowel (D) consonant

4. The root meaning of मात्रा is:

- (A) 'colour' (B) 'measure'
(C) 'caste' (D) 'sound'

5. वर्णमात्रा (sound-duration) belongs to the study of:

- (A) history (B) phonetics (the sounds of Sanskrit)
(C) mathematics (D) geography

6. How many vowel quantities (मात्राः) does Sanskrit recognise?

- (A) two (B) four
(C) one (D) three

7. The three vowel quantities are:

- (A) short and long only (B) high, middle and low pitch
(C) past, present and future (D) ह्रस्व (short), दीर्घ (long), प्लुत (prolonged)

8. The most common mistake about Sanskrit vowel-length is:

- (A) adding a fourth length
(B) forgetting प्लुत and assuming only two lengths
(C) ignoring short vowels (D) counting consonants

9. Unlike many languages with two vowel-lengths, Sanskrit has:

- (A) a third, the प्लुत (prolonged) (B) only one length
(C) no vowel lengths (D) ten lengths

10. The three quantities differ in their:

- (A) duration (how long the vowel is held) (B) colour
(C) spelling (D) caste

11. Ordering by length from shortest to longest, the three are:

- (A) प्लुत, दीर्घ, ह्रस्व (B) ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत
(C) दीर्घ, ह्रस्व, प्लुत (D) ह्रस्व, प्लुत, दीर्घ

12. ह्रस्व means:

- (A) long (2 matras) (B) prolonged (3 matras)
(C) short (1 matra) (D) silent

13. The descriptive name अल्पकालिक: ('short-time') refers to which class?

- (A) दीर्घ (long) (B) प्लुत (prolonged)
(C) ह्रस्व (short) (D) consonants

14. How many matras does a ह्रस्व vowel last?

- (A) two (B) three
(C) one (D) zero

15. Which are examples of ह्रस्व (short) vowels?

- (A) अ, इ, उ (B) आ, ई, ऊ
(C) the calls भो-3, राम-3 (D) क, ख, ग (consonants)

16. दीर्घ means:

- (A) long (2 matras) (B) short (1 matra)
(C) prolonged (3 matras) (D) silent

17. The descriptive name लम्बकालिक: ('long-time') refers to which class?

- (A) ह्रस्व (short) (B) प्लुत (prolonged)
(C) दीर्घ (long) (D) consonants

18. How many matras does a दीर्घ vowel last?

- (A) one (B) three
(C) two (D) four

19. Which are examples of दीर्घ (long) vowels?

- (A) अ, इ, उ (B) the drawn-out call भो-३
(C) आ, ई, ऊ (D) consonants only

20. प्लुत means:

- (A) prolonged (3 matras) (B) short (1 matra)
(C) long (2 matras) (D) silent

21. The descriptive name अतिविलम्बकालिकः refers to which class?

- (A) प्लुत (prolonged) (B) ह्रस्व (short)
(C) दीर्घ (long) (D) consonants

22. How many matras does a प्लुत vowel last?

- (A) one (B) three
(C) two (D) zero

23. प्लुत vowels are mostly used in:

- (A) everyday quick speech (B) chanting and dramatic calls (e.g. भो-३ राम!)
(C) writing numbers (D) silent reading only

24. A प्लुत vowel should be:

- (A) said as quickly as possible (B) skipped entirely
(C) whispered
(D) drawn out (held three times as long as a short vowel)

25. If a प्लुत vowel is said quickly, it wrongly becomes:

- (A) a short vowel only (B) a consonant
(C) a whole word (D) a long (दीर्घ) vowel, not a प्लुत

26. कुक्कुटः रौति means:

- (A) the crow flies (B) the peacock dances
(C) the rooster crows (D) the mongoose runs

27. कुक्कुटः means:

- (A) a rooster / cock (B) a crow
(C) a sparrow (D) a pigeon

28. कुक्कुटः is glossed as कृकवाकुः, and the word is:

- (A) onomatopoeic (mimicking the rooster's call)
(B) borrowed from English (C) a number
(D) a verb

29. The rooster's crow is a good phonics example because it:

- (A) naturally spans short, long and prolonged sounds
(B) has no sound (C) is always silent
(D) uses only consonants

30. The grammarian famous for using कुक्कुटः to illustrate vowel-quantity was:

- (A) Bankim Chandra (B) Savarkar
(C) Panini (D) Aryabhata

31. रौति means:

- (A) (they) cry - plural (B) (it) flies
(C) (it) crows / cries - singular (D) (it) runs

32. रुवन्ति means:

- (A) (it) cries - singular (B) (they) fly
(C) (it) runs (D) (they) cry / crow - plural

33. The difference between रौति and रुवन्ति is one of:

- (A) tense (past vs present) (B) gender
(C) number (singular vs plural) (D) vowel length

34. For one rooster, the correct verb is:

- (A) रुवन्ति (plural) (B) रौति (singular)
(C) अमारयत् (he killed) (D) गच्छन्ति (they go)

35. For many roosters, the correct verb is:

- (A) रौति (singular) (B) रुवन्ति (plural)
(C) रौतु (let it crow) (D) अरौत् (it crowed)

36. Choosing रौति vs रुवन्ति illustrates Sanskrit's rule of:

- (A) vowel length (B) verb-subject agreement in number
(C) caste (D) direction words

37. वायसः means:

- (A) a rooster (B) a peacock
(C) a crow (D) a sparrow

38. शिखी means:

- (A) a peacock (B) a crow
(C) a pigeon (D) a mongoose

39. कपोतः means:

(A) a peacock

(C) a cuckoo

(B) a sparrow

(D) a pigeon

40. चटका means:

(A) a crow

(C) a sparrow

(B) a peacock

(D) a pigeon

41. नकुलः means:

(A) a mouse

(C) a crow

(B) a mongoose

(D) a pigeon

42. मूषकः means:

(A) a mongoose

(C) a sparrow

(B) a peacock

(D) a mouse / rat

43. पुंस्कोकिलः means:

(A) a female crow

(C) a peacock

(B) a male cuckoo

(D) a mongoose

44. These Sanskrit words (वायसः, शिखी, नकुलः, चटका) are all names of:

(A) vowels

(C) castes

(B) verbs

(D) birds and animals

45. भेदः means:

(A) a sub-type

(C) a vowel

(B) a type / kind

(D) a verb

46. उपभेदः means:

(A) a main type

(C) a sub-type (a division within a type)

(B) a vowel

(D) a bird

47. The relationship between भेदः and उपभेदः is that an उपभेदः is:

(A) a subdivision of a भेदः

(C) the same as a भेदः

(B) larger than a भेदः

(D) unrelated to a भेदः

48. ध्यानं निदधतु means:

(A) go away

(C) keep silent forever

(B) sit down

(D) please pay attention

49. ध्यानं निदधतु is a polite:

(A) imperative (a respectful request)

(C) question

(B) past tense

(D) plural noun

50. A teacher beginning a lesson might say ध्यानं निदधतु to:

(A) scold the students

(C) count the students

(B) dismiss the class

(D) politely ask students to pay attention

51. The word वर्ण in वर्णमात्रा means:

- (A) caste / class (B) a bird
(C) a verb (D) a letter / sound (phonetics)

52. वर्ण can also mean 'caste/class' in social texts, showing Sanskrit's:

- (A) lack of vocabulary
(B) polysemy (one word, several meanings by context)
(C) inability to mean more than one thing (D) use of only one sense ever

53. In this chapter, the relevant sense of वर्ण is:

- (A) sound / letter (because it is about वर्णमात्रा, sound-duration)
(B) caste (C) colour only
(D) a bird

54. Which word-meaning pair is CORRECT?

- (A) कुक्कुटः = rooster (B) वायसः = peacock
(C) चटका = pigeon (D) शिखी = crow

55. Which vowel-quantity pair is CORRECT?

- (A) ह्रस्व = 3 matras; प्लुत = 1 matra (B) दीर्घ = 1 matra
(C) प्लुत = 2 matras (D) ह्रस्व = 1 matra; प्लुत = 3 matras

56. Which verb-number pair is CORRECT?

- (A) रौति = plural; रुवन्ति = singular (B) both singular
(C) both plural (D) रौति = singular; रुवन्ति = plural

57. Which bird/animal pair is CORRECT?

- (A) नकुलः = mouse; मूषकः = mongoose (B) both = crow
(C) नकुलः = mongoose; मूषकः = mouse (D) both = peacock

58. The main purpose of this supplementary chapter is to teach:

- (A) the rise of empires
(B) the three vowel quantities (matra) and related vocabulary
(C) banking and finance (D) the cycle of food

59. Putting it together, why does Sanskrit pay close attention to vowel-quantity?

- (A) because it has no consonants (B) because it has only one vowel
(C) because length never matters
(D) because vowel length is phonemic - it can change a word's meaning and is vital in chanting

60. A student claims: 'Sanskrit has only two vowel-lengths, and रौति is plural.' The best correction is:

- (A) the student is fully correct
(B) Sanskrit has three (ह्रस्व, दीर्घ, प्लुत), and रौति is singular (रुवन्ति is plural)

(C) Sanskrit has three, but रैति is plural (D) Sanskrit has two, and रैति is singular

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 13: वर्णमात्रा-परिचयः (Varna-Matra: Vowel Quantity)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks 240.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	B	21	A	31	C	41	B	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	B	32	D	42	D	52	B
3	A	13	C	23	B	33	C	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	B	44	D	54	A
5	B	15	A	25	D	35	B	45	B	55	D
6	D	16	A	26	C	36	B	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	A	37	C	47	A	57	C
8	B	18	C	28	A	38	A	48	D	58	B
9	A	19	C	29	A	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	A	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** वर्णमात्रा refers to a vowel's duration (how long it is sounded). It is not about colour, caste, or spelling.
- (D)** A मात्रा is a unit of time (duration). It is not weight, distance, or money.
- (A)** One मात्रा is the duration of a short vowel. Long and prolonged vowels take two and three; a consonant is not the measure.
- (B)** मात्रा's root meaning is 'measure' (cf. mensuration). It does not mean colour, caste, or sound.
- (B)** वर्णमात्रा belongs to phonetics, the study of sounds. Not history, mathematics, or geography.
- (D)** Sanskrit recognises three vowel quantities. Not two, four, or one.
- (D)** They are ह्रस्व (short), दीर्घ (long) and प्लुत (prolonged). Not just two, nor pitches, nor tenses.

- 8. (B)** The common mistake is forgetting प्लुत and assuming only two lengths. Not adding a fourth, ignoring short vowels, or counting consonants.
- 9. (A)** Sanskrit adds a third length, the प्लुत. It does not have only one, none, or ten.
- 10. (A)** They differ in duration. Not colour, spelling, or caste.
- 11. (B)** Shortest to longest: ह्रस्व (1), दीर्घ (2), प्लुत (3). The other orders are wrong.
- 12. (C)** ह्रस्व means 'short' (1 mātrā). Long is दीर्घ (2), prolonged प्लुत (3); it is not silent.
- 13. (C)** अल्पकालिक: ('short-time') is ह्रस्व. दीर्घ is लम्बकालिक: and प्लुत अतिविलम्बकालिक:; consonants are not meant.
- 14. (C)** A ह्रस्व vowel lasts one mātrā. Two is दीर्घ, three प्लुत; it is not zero.
- 15. (A)** अ, इ, उ are short (ह्रस्व) vowels. आ, ई, ऊ are long, the drawn-out calls are प्लुत, and क, ख, ग are consonants.
- 16. (A)** दीर्घ means 'long' (2 mātrās). Short is ह्रस्व (1), prolonged प्लुत (3); it is not silent.
- 17. (C)** लम्बकालिक: ('long-time') is दीर्घ. ह्रस्व is अल्पकालिक: and प्लुत अतिविलम्बकालिक:; consonants are not meant.
- 18. (C)** A दीर्घ vowel lasts two mātrās. One is ह्रस्व, three प्लुत; it is not four.
- 19. (C)** आ, ई, ऊ are long (दीर्घ) vowels. अ, इ, उ are short, the drawn-out call is प्लुत, and consonants are not vowels.
- 20. (A)** प्लुत means 'prolonged' (3 mātrās). Short is ह्रस्व (1), long दीर्घ (2); it is not silent.
- 21. (A)** अतिविलम्बकालिक: ('very-delayed-time') is प्लुत. ह्रस्व is अल्पकालिक: and दीर्घ लम्बकालिक:; consonants are not meant.
- 22. (B)** A प्लुत vowel lasts three mātrās. One is ह्रस्व, two दीर्घ; it is not zero.
- 23. (B)** प्लुत vowels appear mainly in chanting and dramatic calls. Not everyday quick speech, number-writing, or silent reading.
- 24. (D)** A प्लुत vowel is drawn out, held three times as long as a short vowel. It is not said quickly, skipped, or whispered.
- 25. (D)** Said quickly, a प्लुत collapses into a long (दीर्घ) vowel. It does not become merely short, a consonant, or a word.
- 26. (C)** कुक्कुटः रौति means 'the rooster crows'. It is not about a crow flying, a peacock dancing, or a mongoose running.

- 27. (A)** कुक्कुटः means a rooster / cock. A crow is वायसः, a sparrow चटका, and a pigeon कपोतः.
- 28. (A)** कुक्कुटः is onomatopoeic, mimicking the rooster's call. It is not an English loan, a number, or a verb.
- 29. (A)** The crow naturally spans short, long and prolonged sounds, illustrating the three mātrās. It is not soundless, silent, or consonant-only.
- 30. (C)** Panini used कुक्कुटः to illustrate vowel-quantity. Bankim Chandra, Savarkar and Aryabhata are from other chapters.
- 31. (C)** रौति is singular, '(it) crows / cries'. The plural is रुवन्ति; it does not mean fly or run.
- 32. (D)** रुवन्ति is plural, '(they) cry / crow'. The singular is रौति; it does not mean fly or run.
- 33. (C)** They differ in number (singular vs plural), not tense, gender, or vowel length.
- 34. (B)** For one rooster the singular रौति is correct. रुवन्ति is plural, and the others are unrelated verbs.
- 35. (B)** For many roosters the plural रुवन्ति is correct. रौति is singular, रौतु imperative, and अरौत् past.
- 36. (B)** It illustrates verb-subject agreement in number. Not vowel length, caste, or direction words.
- 37. (C)** वायसः means 'a crow'. A rooster is कुक्कुटः, a peacock शिखी, and a sparrow चटका.
- 38. (A)** शिखी means 'a peacock'. A crow is वायसः, a pigeon कपोतः, and a mongoose नकुलः.
- 39. (D)** कपोतः means 'a pigeon'. A peacock is शिखी, a sparrow चटका, and a cuckoo कोकिलः.
- 40. (C)** चटका means 'a sparrow'. A crow is वायसः, a peacock शिखी, and a pigeon कपोतः.
- 41. (B)** नकुलः means 'a mongoose'. A mouse is मूषकः, a crow वायसः, and a pigeon कपोतः.
- 42. (D)** मूषकः means 'a mouse / rat'. A mongoose is नकुलः, a peacock शिखी, and a sparrow चटका.
- 43. (B)** पुंस्कोकिलः means 'a male cuckoo'. It is not a female crow, a peacock, or a mongoose.
- 44. (D)** वायसः, शिखी, नकुलः and चटका are all names of birds and animals. Not vowels, verbs, or castes.
- 45. (B)** भेदः means 'a type / kind'. A sub-type is उपभेदः; it is not a vowel or a verb.
- 46. (C)** उपभेदः means 'a sub-type'. A main type is भेदः; it is not a vowel or a bird.

47. (A) An उपभेदः is a subdivision of a भेदः. It is not larger, the same, or unrelated.
48. (D) ध्यानं निदधतु means 'please pay attention'. It does not mean go away, sit down, or keep silent forever.
49. (A) ध्यानं निदधतु is a polite imperative (a respectful request). It is not a past tense, a question, or a noun.
50. (D) A teacher says ध्यानं निदधतु to politely ask students to pay attention. Not to scold, dismiss, or count them.
51. (D) In वर्णमात्रा, वर्ण means a letter / sound (phonetics). It is not caste, a bird, or a verb here.
52. (B) That वर्ण means both 'sound' and 'caste' shows polysemy - one word, several meanings by context. It is not a lack of vocabulary or single-sense.
53. (A) Here वर्ण means sound / letter, since the chapter is about वर्णमात्रा (sound-duration). Not caste, colour-only, or a bird.
54. (A) कुक्कुटः = rooster. वायसः is a crow (not peacock), चटका a sparrow (not pigeon), and शिखी a peacock (not crow).
55. (D) ह्रस्व = 1 mātrā and प्लुत = 3 mātrās. दीर्घ is 2 mātrās; the reversal and other values are wrong.
56. (D) रौति = singular and रुवन्ति = plural. The reversal and 'both same' options are wrong.
57. (C) नकुलः = mongoose and मूषकः = mouse. The reversal and 'both same' options are wrong.
58. (B) Its purpose is to teach the three vowel quantities (mātrā) and related vocabulary. Not empires, banking, or the food cycle.
59. (D) Vowel length is phonemic - it can change meaning and matters in chanting. Sanskrit has consonants and many vowels, and length does matter.
60. (B) Sanskrit has three vowel-lengths and रौति is singular (रुवन्ति is plural). The other options keep one or both errors.